MILITARY SPECIFICATION

SHEET, BED, COTTON, WHITE, FITTED STYLE

This limited coordination Military specification has been prepared by the Defense Personnel Support Center based upon currently available technical information. It is subject to modification. However, pending its promulgation as a coordinated Military specification, it may be used in procurement.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for cotton, fitted, bed sheets.

1.2 Classification. The sheets shall be of the following sizes as specified (see 3.2 and 6.2):

Schedule of sizes

Size	Width inches	Length (cut or torn) inches
1	46	91
2	52	94
3	39	64

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

V-T-276	- Thread, Cotton.
UU-P-268	- Paper, Kraft, Untreated, Wrapping.
CCC-C-430	- Cloth, Sheeting, Cotton, and Polyester and Cotton.
DDD-L-20	- Label; for Clothing, Equipage, and Tentage, (General Use).
PPP-B-636	- Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.

FSC 7210

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STANDARDS

Federal

FED-TEST METHOD STD No. 191	- Textile Test Methods.
FED-STD-751	- Stitches, Seams, and Stitching.
FED-TEST METHOD STD No. 601	- Rubber, Sampling and Testing.

Military

MIL-STD-105	- Sampling Procedures and Table for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	- Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MS 16686	- Medical Services Symbol.

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings, and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

RULES AND REGULATIONS UNDER THE TEXTILE FIBER PRODUCTS IDENTIFICATION ACT

(Copies may be obtained without charge from the Federal Trade Commision, Washington, D. C. 20580).

NATIONAL MOTOR FREIGHT TRAFFIC ASSOCIATION, INC., AGENT

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N. W., Washington, D. C. 20036).

UNIFORM CLASSIFICATION COMMITTEE, AGENT

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 202, Union Station, 516 W. Jackson Blvd., Chicago, Illinois 60606).

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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The basic material for the sheets shall be cotton sheeting conforming to type II, class 2, style C of CCC-C-430.

3.1.2 Color of sheet. The sheets shall be bleached white.

3.1.3 Thread. The thread for hemming the sheets shall be cotton conforming to type LA2 or LA3 of V-T-276. When stitch type 301 is used, the thread shall be ticket No. 60, 3 ply. When stitch type 401 is used, the needle thread shall be ticket No. 60, 3 ply and the looper thread shall be ticket No. 70, 2 ply or ticket No. 80, 2 ply.

3.1.3.1 Color of thread. The color of the thread for all types of sheets shall be white.

3.1.4 Binding, cotton, bias-cut. The bias-cut cotton binding for reinforcing the corners and covering the elastic material on both ends of the sheet shall be bleached white cotton conforming to the following requirements:

Physical requirements

Weight, ounces per square yard (minimum)	Yarn per inch			Width
	Warp	Filling	Weave	Inches
2.8	68	72	Plain	1 1/4 ± 1/16

3.1.4.1 Construction of the binding. The cloth which is to be cut into bias binding shall have the selvage edges removed, and shall then be cut on an angle of 45° ± 5°. The binding shall be securely sewn together using bleached white, cotton thread, conforming to type LA2, 3 ply, ticket No. 60 of V-T-276. The stitch type shall be 301, and seam type shall conform to SSa-1 of FED-STD-751, using 8 to 12 stitches per inch.

3.1.5 Elastic material. The elastic material used to secure the ends and corners of the sheet shall be a heat resistant rubber elastic or a rayon elastic braid conforming to the following requirements:

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Physical Requirements

Component	Characteristic	Requirement	Tolerance
Elastic rubber Strip,	Gauge	.025	± .002
	Width, inches	1/4 or 3/8	± 1/32
	Elongation %	600 Minimum	
	Color	White	-
	Composition	Natural Rubber	-
OR			
Rayon, elastic braid	Width, inches	11/32	± 1/32
	Weight per linear yard, ounces	0.15 Minimum	
	Yarn full width:		
	Elastic strands	8 Minimum	
	Carriers	17 Minimum	
	Yarn size	8/1	± 2 counts
	Yarn type	Bright, Natural, Spun rayon	
	Elastic strands:		
	Gauge	40 Maximum fineness	
	Type (Material)	Heat resistant rubber	
Rayon, elastic braid	Stretch, percent	130 Minimum	
	Material contents, percent:		
	Rayon	72	± 3
	Rubber	28	± 3
	Tension, percent:		
	12 ounces weight	40	± 10
	16 ounces weight	70	± 10

3.2 Dimensions. The dimensions of the sheets before hemming shall be as specified in 1.2. A minus tolerance of 1 inch and any plus tolerance in width or length will be permitted. The finished sheets shall fit the following sizes of mattresses:

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Sheet size (1.2)	Mattress size
1 _____	75 inches long x 30 inches wide x 7 inches thick
2 _____	78 inches long x 36 inches wide x 6 1/2 inches thick
3 _____	51 inches long x 26 inches wide x 4 inches thick

3.3 Construction. Unless otherwise specified herein (see 3.4.1), all sheets shall have selvage edges on both sides. The corners of the sheet shall be cut to form 4 box-shaped seams. This shall be done by cutting inward from the selvage and cut edges. The cuts shall be made eight ± 1/2 inches from the corners for sizes 1 and 2 sheets; and five ± 1/2 inches for size 3 sheets. After the cuts have been made, the two cut edges shall be placed together and bound. This shall be done using stitching type 301, seam type BSa-1, with 8 to 12 stitches per inch. Both edges of the binding shall be turned under 3/16 to 1/4 inch. The finished item shall thereby have four box-shaped seams.

or

As an alternate method, the sewn-in corners may be finished with a double-lapped, double-stitched seam, using stitch type 301 or 401, seam type LSc-2 with 8 to 12 stitches per inch, thread LA2, 3 ply, ticket No. 60 of V-T-276.

3.3.1 Application of binding and elastic material. The elastic material and the cotton binding shall be sewn to both ends (cut) of the sheet. The cotton binding shall cover the elastic material and the cut edges of the sheeting. This operation shall be performed using stitch type 301, seam type Bsa-1, with 8 to 12 stitches per inch. The turn-under shall be not less than 3/16 inch and the binding shall finish not less than 3/8 inch, both sides. The elastic material shall be applied so that the sheet will provide a snug fit over a mattress having a thickness of seven inches for size 1 sheet, 6 1/2 inches for size 2 sheet and 4 inches for size 3 sheet. The elastic material and the binding shall extend 7 to 8 inches beyond the boxed-seams for size 1 and 2 sheets and 4 to 5 inches for size 3 sheets, when measured in a stretched position.

3.4 Hems. All hems shall be straight and of uniform width. Stitches, seams, and stitchings shall conform to Fed-Std. 751. Hems shall be sewn so that no raw edges, run-offs, twists, pleats, puckers, or open seams result. Ends of all seams and stitchings when not caught in other seams or stitchings shall be backtacked or backstitched not less than 1/2 inch. Thread breaks shall be secured by stitching back of the breaks not less than 1/2 inch at each break. All thread ends shall be trimmed to a length of not more than 1/2 inch.

3.4.1 Alternate hems. These sheets may contain a side hem 3/16 to 1/4 inch wide in lieu of one selvage. The side hem shall be sewn using stitch type 301 or 401, seam type EFb-1 with 8 to 12 stitches per inch. The turn-under shall be 1/8 to 3/16 inch. The stitching shall be placed 1/32 to 1/16 inch from the turned edge.

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3.5 Marking. Each sheet shall be marked with a caduceus of appropriate size, centered between the letter "U" and "S", in accordance with type I of MS-16686. The legend "US" shall be in block type, 1/2 inch in height. Markings shall conform to type III and IV, class 9 of DDD-L-20, except that fastness shall be as specified for class 4 marking. For the purpose of determining marking fastness, the end item is intended to be laundered. Marking shall be placed not more than 1 inch above selvage edge and between 1 and 2 inches from the end of the bound elastic material on either corner.

3.6 Fiber identification. Each sheet shall be labeled for fiber content in accordance with the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act.

3.7 Workmanship. The finished sheets shall conform to the quality and grade of product established by this specification. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirement specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.2.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be tested in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, standards, and drawings, unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.2.1.1 In addition to the quality assurance provisions of the subsidiary specifications, the basic cloth for the binding and the elastic material shall be tested for the characteristics specified in accordance with the referenced test methods of Fed Test Method-STD-601 or Fed Test Method-STD-191, where applicable, and as listed herein. The test values specified in section 3 apply to the test results of determinations made on a sample unit, as specified in the applicable test method. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one linear yard, full width, of the elastic material and of the cloth for the binding before cutting. The sample unit for test purposes shall be two linear yards, full width. The lot shall be unacceptable if one or more units fail to meet any requirements specified. All test reports shall contain the individual values utilized in expressing the final result. The sample size shall be as follows:

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Lot size (linear yard)	Sample size (No. of units)
800 or less	2
801 up to and including 22,000	3
22,001 and over	5

Testing of components

Item	Characteristic	Requirement Paragraph	Test Method
Binding Cotton (Cloth)	Weave 1/	3.1.3	Visual
	Yarn per inch:		
	Warp	3.1.3	5050 Fed-Test Method Std-191
	Filling	3.1.3	5050 Fed-Test Method Std-191
	Weight, ounces per square yard	3.1.3	5041 Fed-Test Method STD-191
	Identification of material 2/	3.1.3	1200 Fed-Test Method Std-191
	Width	3.1.3	5020 Fed-Test Method Std-191
Elastic, Rubber Strip	Color	3.1.4	Visual
	Thickness	3.1.4	2011 of Fed-Test Method Std-601
	Composition 2/	3.1.4	
	Elongation, percent	3.1.4	4121 of Fed-Test Method Std-601
	Width	3.1.4	2121 Fed-Test Method Std-601
Rayon Elastic Braid	Width	3.1.4	5020 of Fed-Test Method Std-191
	Weight	3.1.4	5041 of Fed-Test Method Std-191 3/
	Yarn, full width:		
	Elastic strands	3.1.4	5050 of Fed-Test Method Std-191
	Carriers	3.1.4	5050 of Fed-Test Method Std-191
	Yarn size 2/	3.1.4	
	Yarn type 2/	3.1.4	
	Elastic strands:		
	Gage	3.1.4	4.2.1.2
	Type (Material) 2/	3.1.4	
	Stretch, percent	3.1.4	4.2.1.3
	Material Content, percent 2/	3.1.4	

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Testing of Components(cont'd)

Item	Characteristic	Requirement Paragraph	Test Method
	Tension, percent: 2/ 12 ounce weight 16 ounce weight	3.1.4	

1/ One determination per sample unit with results reported as "pass" or "fail".
2/ A certificate of compliance will be accepted for this characteristic.
3/ A sample four inches in length shall be used.

4.2.1.2 Gage of rubber. The gage of rubber shall be determined by counting the actual number of strands, laid side by side, contained in one inch. The gage is equivalent to the actual number of rubber strands contained in one inch. A measuring device which measures the gage of the rubber strands may be utilized providing results are comparable.

4.2.1.3 Stretch, percent. A full width sample of the elastic braid, not less than twenty inches long shall be laid on a flat horizontal surface without tension. A ten inch portion of the braid shall be marked off and stretched to a minimum of twenty-three inches. The stretched length shall be recorded and the percent of stretch computed as follows:

$$\text{Stretch, percent} = \frac{L_2 - L_1 \times 100}{L_1}$$

where:
L_1 =Original length prior to stretching.
L_2 =Stretched length."

4.2.2 Examination of the end item. Defects found during the examination shall be classified in accordance with 4.2.2.1 thru 4.2.2.4. The sample unit shall be one sheet. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one sheet each.

4.2.2.1 Visual examination. The required number of sheets shall be inspected and defects classified as listed in table I. The defects found shall be counted regardless of their proximity to each other, except where two or more defects represent a single local condition in the sheet, in which case only the most serious defect shall be counted.

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TABLE I. Visual defects

Defects	Classification Major	Minor
Hole, cut, tear, or smash	X	
Floats or skips:		
Multiple, 1/2 inch or more in area	X	
Multiple, less than 1/2 inch in area		X
Single, over 9 inches in length		X
Broken or missing yarns:		
Three or more, less than 9 inches apart regardless of length	X	
Two, less than 9 inches apart over three inches in length		X
Hitchback:		
Distorted, 2 square inches or more in area	X	
Distorted area less than 2 square inches and more than 1 square inch		X
Slub, slug, gout, jerked-in filling or slough off:		
Over 1/8 inch in thickness	X	
1/16 to 1/8 inch in thickness		X
Spot, stain or streak:		
Exceeding 1 inch in longest dimension	X	
More than 1/4 inch but not exceeding 1 inch in longest dimension		X
Accumulation of spots or stains 1/4 inch or less in longest dimension (5 or more per sheet)		X
Heavy place		X
Light place or thin place:		
Three inches or less in longest dimension		X
More than 3 inches in longest dimension	X	
Color not as specified	X	
Temple cuts or abrasion marks		X
Selvages:		
Omitted (not as specified)	X	
Seams and stitching:		
Open seams unless otherwise specified		
Up to and including 1/2 inch		X

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TABLE I. Visual defects (cont'd)

Defects	Classification Major	Minor
Over 1/2 inch	X	
NOTE: A seam shall be classified as open when one or more stitches joining a seam are broken or when two or more continuous skipped stitches or runoffs occur.		
Seam type or stitch type other than specified	X	
Hems:		
Alternate types when applicable - hemmed other than specified		X
Turn-under not as specified		X
Any hem omitted	X	
Width of hem more or less than specified		X
Hem twisted, pleated or puckered		X
Stitches per inch:		
Up to and including two stitches per inch less than minimum specified		X
More than two stitches per inch less than specified	X	
More than two stitches per inch in excess of maximum specified	X	
Up to and including two stitches per inch in excess of maximum specified		X
Stitching margin:		
Not as specified		X
Stitching ends (When not caught in other seams and stitching):		
Not backstitched or backtacked	X	
Backstitched or backtacked less than 1/2 inch		X
Thread ends not trimmed as specified		X
Thread breaks:		
Stitched back of break less than 1/2 inch		X
NOTE: Thread breaks not seamed back of the break shall be classified as open seam.		
Stitch tension:		
Loose tension, resulting in loose needle or bobbin thread; tight tension resulting in tightness or puckering of material at stitch line		X

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TABLE I. Visual defects (cont'd)

Defects	Classification Major	Minor
Raw edge:		
Up to and including 1/2 inch		X
Over 1/2 inch	X	
Binding not securely attached	X	
Elastic material not securely attached	X	
Binding omitted	X	
Elastic material omitted	X	
Box-shaped seams not formed as specified	X	
Marking (when specified) omitted, incomplete, illegible, incorrect, wrong color or misplaced	X	

4.2.2.2 Sheet inspection quality. Each sheet in the sample size shall be designated as first or second quality for inspection purposes only, in accordance with 4.2.2.2.1 and 4.2.2.2.2.

4.2.2.2.1 A first quality sheet shall be defined as follows:

Contains no major defect listed.
Contains no more than 4 minor defects listed.

4.2.2.2.2 A second quality sheet shall be defined as a sheet that does not meet the provisions of a first quality sheet (see 4.2.2.2.1), but does adhere to the following:

Contains no hole, cut, tear or smash.
Contains not more than three of the other major defects listed.
Contains not more than eight total defects (majors(except hole, cut, tear or smash which are not permitted) and minors).

4.2.2.3 Inspection level and acceptable quality level (AQL).

4.2.2.3.1 For first quality sheets. The inspection level shall be level I of MIL-STD-105 and the AQL for first quality sheets shall be 4.0 percent defective (seconds). Any sheet in the sample that does not meet criteria for first or second quality sheets (see 4.2.2.2.1 and 4.2.2.2.2) shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.2.2.3.2 For second quality sheets. The inspection level shall be level I of MIL-STD-105 for second quality sheets. Any sheet that does not meet the criteria for first or second quality sheets (see 4.2.2.2.1 and 4.2.2.2.2) shall be cause for rejection of the lot of seconds.

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4.2.2.4 Dimensional examination. Each of the following defects listed shall be counted not more than once in each sheet examined. The sample size shall be in accordance with level S-3. The AQL shall be 2.5 defects per one hundred units.

Finished width	- less than specified (see 1.2 and 3.2).
Length (cut or torn)	- less than specified (see 1.2 and 3.2).
Biased	- more than 2 inches

4.2.3 Examination of preparation for delivery requirements. An examination shall be made to determine that packaging, packing, and marking comply with the section 5 requirements. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery with the exception that it need not be sealed. Defects of closure listed below shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 2.5 defects per one hundred units.

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; or improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing, damaged, or not as specified.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete closure of container flaps, improper taping, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. Open and non-continuous heat sealed seams and closure of polyethylene bag. Omission of vent hole in polyethylene bag. Bulging or distortion of container.
Content	Number of interior packages per container is more or less than required. Number of sheets per wrapped bundle, sheet per bag, or bag per bundle is more or less than required. 1/

1/ For this defect, one (1) wrapped bundle, three (3) bags or one (1) bagged bundle, as applicable, shall be examined from each shipping container in the sample.

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be Level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One sheet, as specified constitutes one unit of issue.

5.1.2 Level A.

5.1.2.1 Unit package. Each sheet shall be neatly folded to approximately 9 inches by 10 1/2 inches. Each sheet shall then be inserted in a snug-fitting flat style, clear, polyethylene film bag of 0.00125 inch thickness (± 2 percent tolerance). The polyethylene bag shall be formed with heat sealed seams that are straight, continuous and parallel to each other and the formed edges of the bag. The final heat seal closure to the bag shall be made as close as possible to the open end. A 1/4-inch maximum diameter hole shall be made at one corner of each polyethylene bag to allow the excess air to escape.

5.1.3 Level C. Sheets shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against physical damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. The supplier may use his standard practice when it meets this requirement.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be Level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A.

5.2.1.1 Exterior container. Thirty sheets of one size, type and color only, packaged as specified in 5.1.2.1 shall be packed in a fiberboard box conforming to style RSC-L, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The inside of each box shall be fitted with a taped box liner conforming to type CF, class weather-resistant, variety DW, grade V15c of PPP-B-636. Box shall be closed and waterproofed in accordance with the appendix of the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B.

5.2.2.1 Exterior container. Thirty sheets of one size, type and color only packaged as specified in 5.1.2.1 shall be packed in a fiberboard box conforming to style RSC-L, type CF (varierty SW) or SF, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The inside of each box shall be fitted with a taped box liner conforming to type CF, class domestic, variety DW, grade 200 of PPP-B-636. Box shall be closed by method II of PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C. Sheets packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. Containers shall be in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification Rules or National Motor Freight Classification Rules, as applicable.

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5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Unit package. Each unit package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Marking shall be legibly printed or stamped in black directly on the bag across the center face or on a white paper label inserted within the bag so as to permit ready identification.

5.3.2 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES.

6.1 Intended use. The sheets covered by this specification are intended for use as bed sheets.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Size required (see 1.2).
(c) Hems required (see 3.4 and 3.4.1).
(d) Whether marking for medical procurement is required (see 3.5).
(e) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2)
(f) Whether seconds are acceptable and the percentage of acceptable seconds.

6.3 This specification does not include all types, classes, styles or sizes of the commodity indicated by the title of this specification, or which are commercially available, but is intended to cover the items, which are normally procured to meet military requirements.

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Review activities:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
Defense Supply Agency - DM

Project No. 7210-0169

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Defense Supply Agency

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

OMB Approval
No. 22-R255

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE
MIL-S-36868 (DSA-DM)

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A
☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?
   A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

   B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?
   ☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address - Optional)*

TELEPHONE NO.

DATE

DD FORM 1 JAN 72 1426

REPLACES EDITION OF 1 JAN 68 WHICH MAY BE USED

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